

Karya pays the workers nearly 20 times the prevailing market rate, to ensure they maintain a high quality of work. According to a news report, over 32,000 crowdsourced workers have logged into the app in India, completing 40 million digital tasks, including image recognition, contour alignments, video annotation, and speech annotation. Karya is now a sought-after partner for tech giants like Microsoft and Google, who aim to ultra-localise AI.

On the tech front, people are betting on quantum computing to give AI an unprecedented thrust. With that kind of computing power, AI can help us understand several natural phenomena and find ways to sort out problems ranging from poverty to global warming.

And then, there is xAI, Elon Musk's 'truth-seeking' AI model. Released to a select audience in November this year, it is touted to be a serious competition for OpenAI's ChatGPT, Google's Bard, and Anthropic's Claude. In another interesting marketing spin, we see AI being positioned as a coworker or collaborator, assuaging the job-stealer image it has acquired. Recently released Microsoft Copilot hopes to be your 'everyday AI companion,' taking mundane tasks off users' minds, reducing their stress, and helping them to collaborate and work better. Microsoft thinks Copilot subscriptions could rake in more than \$10 billion per year by 2026.

From online retail, quick-service restaurants and social media platforms to financial institutions, innumerable organisations seem to be introducing AI-driven features in their products and platforms. In a media report, Shopify's Chief Financial Officer Jeff Hoffmeister remarked that the company's AI tools are like a 'superpower' for sellers. Google has also been talking about their latest AI features

helping small businesses and merchants create an impact this holiday season. Google's AI-powered Product Studio lets merchants and advertisers create new product imagery for free, simply by typing in a prompt of the image they want to use. Airbnb also seems to be betting big on AI. If rumours are to be believed, Instagram is working on a trailblazing feature that lets users create personalised AI chatbots that can engage in conversations, answer questions, and offer support.

On the usage front, people continue to find interesting uses for AI, even as many industry leaders have barred their employees from using it for writing code and other content. A South Indian movie maker, for example, used AI to create a younger version of the lead actor, for the flashback scenes.

The more AI is used, the more we hear of lawsuits being filed against AI companies—concerning misinformation, defamation, intellectual property rights, and more. Recently, Scarlett Johansson (Black Widow in the Avengers movies) filed a case against Lisa AI, for using her face and voice in an AI-generated advertisement, without her permission. Tom Hanks also alerted his fans of a video promoting a dental plan that used an AI version of him, without his permission. According to a report in The Guardian, comedian Sarah Silverman has also sued OpenAI and Meta for copyright infringement.

The job dilemma

Elon Musk famously remarked to Sunak during the Bletchley Summit that AI has the potential to take away all jobs! "You can have a job if you want a job... but AI will be able to do everything. It's hard to say exactly what that moment is, but there will come a point where no job is needed," he said. A 2023

report by Goldman Sachs also says that two-thirds of occupations could be partially automated by AI. The *Future of Jobs 2023* report by the World Economic Forum states that, "Artificial intelligence, a key driver of potential algorithmic displacement, is expected to be adopted by nearly 75% of surveyed companies and is expected to lead to high churn—with 50% of organisations expecting it to create job growth and 25% expecting it to create job losses."

AI is sure to shake-up the jobs as they exist today, but it is also likely to create new job opportunities. Recent research by Pearson, for ServiceNow, revealed that AI and automation will require 16.2 million workers in India to reskill and upskill, while also creating 4.7 million new tech jobs. According to the report, technology will transform the tasks that make up each job but presents an unprecedented chance for Indian workers to reshape and future-proof their careers. With NASSCOM predicting that AI and automation could add up to \$500 billion to India's GDP by 2025, it would be wise for people to skill up to work 'with' AI in the coming year. AI's insatiable thirst for data is also creating more job opportunities, not just for the tech workforce, but also for non-skilled rural population, as Karya has proven. NASSCOM predicts that India alone is expected to have nearly one million data annotation workers by 2030!

It is clear from happenings around the world that no country intends to strike down AI. Of course, the risks are real too, which makes regulations essential—and it does seem to be raining regulations this monsoon. Indeed, ethical, and safe use of AI is likely to be the dominant theme of 2024, but rather than killing AI, it will eventually strengthen the ecosystem further, leading to controlled and responsible growth and adoption. **EFY**